



Self-driving in China

China is all set to allow the testing of self-driving cars on public roads in the country.
<http://digit.in/CarsChina>



New Hyperloop speed record

Virgin Hyperloop's pod just clocked 240 mph, topping Elon Musk's 220-mph mark.
<http://digit.in/RechHyper>

The screenshot shows the 'make-fortune' agent configuration in the Dialogflow console. The 'General' tab is selected. It displays a description field, a default time zone set to '(GMT+5:30) Asia/Colombo', and the Google Project ID 'make-fortune (Google Cloud CF | Actions on Google CF)'. The API version is set to 'Dialogflow V2 API [beta]'. A 'SAVE' button is visible in the top right corner.

Creating your Agent

tomatically expands on the phrases you provide and understands many more variations of them.

- Let us create an intent that defines how users need to provide their birth date and favourite colour to generate their fortune.
- Start by clicking on **Integrations** in the left navigation, and make sure the Google Assistant card is enabled.
- In the left navigation, click the + icon by the Intents menu item.
- In the Intent name field, enter **make-fortune**.
- In the **User says** field, enter **My birth date is May** and hit Enter.
- Click and highlight the String **May** and assign it the **@sys.date** entity in the drop-down menu that appears.
- Provide a few more variations of the response phrases like: **May, I was born in May** etc.
- In the Actions section, select the **REQUIRED** checkbox for the date parameter. This tells Dialogflow to not trigger the intent until the parameter is properly provided by the user.
- Click on **Define prompts** for the parameter and provide a reprompt phrase. This phrase

is spoken to the user repeatedly until the Dialogflow detects a date in the user input.

- In the **Actions** section, create another new parameter to capture the color information just as you have captured date info. This additional parameter uses Dialogflow's built-in "slot-filling" feature, which allows you to obtain additional input parameters from the user without having to create an intent for each one and without having to make the user speak all of the required input in one phrase. Slot filling also lets you set parameters as **Required** so that your agent doesn't process the input until the user provides all required parameters in response.
 - Click **SAVE** to save the entire intent.
- That's it! You've now used Dialogflow to return a static response to the user when they invoke your app. You can also return a real-time fulfillment from the user using the webhook defined earlier. This exercise is left to the user.

PREVIEW THE APP

Now that you have your fulfillment deployed and properly set in Dialogflow, you can preview the app in the Actions simulator. To preview your app, turn on the Web & App Activity, Device In-

formation, and Voice & Audio Activity permissions on the Activity controls page for your Google account. Without this you will not be able to use the Actions Simulator, which lets you test your actions on the web without a hardware device. Click on **try in Google Assistant** link on the upper right hand side of the Actions page.

Note: If you're presented with the Actions simulator splash screen, click Start to authenticate with your Google account.

In the Actions Simulator, type in **talk to my test app** in the Input area of the simulator to begin testing the app. Enter a birth date and then a color when the app prompts you to receive your 'fortune'.

PRE-RELEASE

Now that we have successfully designed conversations and developed actions, let us take a look at how to share them with users. Before you make your agent available to Google Assistant users, however, make sure that it's discoverable and also completely ready for deployment. Here are a few things that you could do to make sure that's the case.

- Review your Actions to verify that they're working properly and comply with Google's policies. Get your apps approved and deployed as smoothly as possible by reviewing them for common errors and easy-to-miss policy violations.
- Get ready for deployment by preparing your assets and information for your listing. As part of the submission process, you provide Google with images and descriptions for use in the Directory listing.
- Review your invocation methods. Follow the guidelines for creating good invocation name and triggering phrases. Users access and find out about your apps through triggering phrases, so it's worthwhile to spend some time reviewing invocation. You may also want to register and reserve your invocation name before you're ready for deployment, just to avoid someone else already reserving it.